IAN RICKETTS



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bestfrend.xyz

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Remote, US

Creative Director

Creative direction for brands and the merchandise that represents them.

Eight years leading creative for brands and the people behind them. I have directed more than ten full rebrands, including Bear Prints to BRANDLAB, where I set the vision and created the name, logo, slogan and business model, and I have helped 60+ companies define who they are and how to show it. I understand what a brand needs to look like to earn trust, what its customers respond to, and how to bring designers, makers and owners together to make it real. Fluency in how the product gets made keeps my direction ambitious and the result exactly as intended.

10+
full rebrands directed, from vision to storefront

60+
companies I have helped define and brand

15+
brand stores built, from identity and color to merch and marketing

400+
production-ready graphics art-directed and shipped

Creative direction

Setting the vision for a brand and the standard for everything that carries it. Naming, identity systems, positioning and voice. Understanding what a client needs beneath what they asked for, and presenting the idea in a way that wins real buy-in. Directing designers, freelancers and AI tools toward one consistent result.

Merch and brand programs

Merchandise as brand expression: apparel, promo, packaging and collateral people want to wear and keep. Garment, style and hardgood choices that fit the brand, the audience and the budget. Branded online stores and merch programs designed, launched and grown with the client.

Leadership and craft

Owned a company, then led a team of seven across sales, art, production and customer service as General Manager. Clear direction, honest feedback and a team people want to do their best work for. Hands-on in Adobe and AI image tools, and fluent across every decoration method, fabric, fit and hardgood. Nothing gets lost between the concept and the shelf.

Tools

Ai Illustrator · Ps Photoshop · Id InDesign · Lr Lightroom · Acrobat

Fulfill Engine 3 yrs, helped shape its development

Also AI image tools, Shopify, Squarespace, HTML/CSS, photo and video

Brands I've built or run

Founder, owner or creative lead

bear prints Screen Printing & Embroidery → BRANDLAB DESIGN.CREATE.WEAR.

WHITE HILL

ROAN

Experience

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BRANDLAB

Late 2022 to present · Redmond, OR

Formerly Bear Prints, est. 1978 · General Manager and Creative Lead · previously Owner, Graphic Designer, Screen Printer

- Directed the full rebrand of a 1978 screen-printing shop into BRANDLAB: set the vision, created the name, logo, slogan and business model, and carried the identity through signage, website, online store and collateral.
- Creative lead for 60+ client brands: defined how each should look and represent itself, then delivered identity, color, merchandise and marketing. Built and launched branded online stores for 15+ of them.
- Built the shop's design function from the ground up; art-direct every client merch program from concept through mockups, virtual proofs and approvals, working closely with owners and marketing teams. 400+ production-ready graphics.
- Guide clients on garments, styles and hardgoods, matching every product to the brand and its audience rather than the price sheet.
- Set production standards and mentor staff on art prep and separations; the work ships the way it was designed.
- Lead a team of seven across sales, art, production and customer service; partnered with the owner to launch the new location from build-out through its February 2026 grand opening.
- Generated ~$345K in revenue as owner-operator, including ~$146K across 14 enterprise-scale orders, by pairing design with consultative selling.

Bestfrend

2018 to present · bestfrend.xyz

Founder, Creative Director and Designer

- Built an independent apparel and art brand from nothing and ran every part of it: the world and voice of the brand, the art, the garments, the photography, the drops, the store and the customer.
- Made the clothing by hand, from sourcing fabric and blanks through cutting, sewing, printing and finishing, then packed and shipped every order. Primary income from 2019 to 2022.
- Added print-on-demand for secondary products, which began three years of POD fluency on top of hands-on production.
- Built and run the storefronts myself; fluent in Shopify and Squarespace from launching and managing the brand's own.
- Everything it takes to start and run a clothing brand, learned by doing it: product, production, pricing, e-commerce, content, fulfillment and community.

White Hill

2026 to present · whitehillweb.com

Founder, Creative Director and Designer · websites and B2B services

- Founded a two-sided studio: websites, SEO and Google services for small businesses, and a SaaS revenue-recovery product for trade contractors.
- Four clients since founding, each taken from discovery through brand, build and launch, with identities designed from scratch where the business needed one.
- Creative lead on every engagement: understanding what the owner is trying to become, then designing the brand and site that gets them there.
- Own the full client relationship, from first conversation through launch, hosting and ongoing care.

Certifications

Inbound Sales Certified
HubSpot Academy · 2026

Customer Success for Sales
Salesforce Trailhead · 2026

KICKOFF Predictive Project Management
Project Management Institute · 2026

Production fluency

Screen printing, separations to press
Embroidery and digitizing prep
DTF and DTG
Laser engraving
Fine-art reproduction

Product fluency

Fabrics, fits and garment styles
Hardgoods and promotional products
Blank and hardgood distributors
Costing, pricing and vendor sourcing

Professional development

Impressions Expo, 2023 to 2025: advanced screen printing, merch e-commerce, pricing and profitability, shop modernization

Also founded

ROAN, joinroan.com. Equestrian and ranch management app: brand, product direction, release management and user support.

Earlier

Squirt Fine Art Printing, Bend, OR. Sales and production, 2018 to 2019. Color and quality control for fine-art reproduction, working directly with artists.

Education

Central Oregon Community College, Bend, OR